

B – 4	A, B, C – 1	P ⁴⁸ – 1
C – 5	A, C, D – 1	P ⁵³ – 1
D – 5	P ⁴⁵ ⲗ, A, B – 1	ⲗ – 29
P ⁴⁵ A – 1	ⲗ, A, B, C – 8	A – 42
ⲗ, A – 2	ⲗ, A, B, D – 2	B – 33
ⲗ, B – 1	A, B, C, D – 1	C – 20
A, D – 1	P ⁸ ⲗ, A, B, D – 1	D – 16
A, 0165 – 1	P ⁴⁵ ⲗ, A, B, C – 1	0165 – 1
B, D – 2	P ⁴⁸ ⲗ, A, B, C – 1	
P ⁴⁵ A, B – 1	ⲗ, A, B, C, D – 2	

Notice the support from the three great ‘Alexandrian’ codices. How could they support something produced in the 12th century? Let me say that again: how could IV century MSS support something that did not exist until the 12th? Out of a total of 131 sets, **f**³⁵ is alone 68 times (52%) and has some early support 63 times (48%). Here again, **f**³⁵ is independent of the lines of transmission represented by the early MSS that I included, so there is no pattern. Since there is no pattern, there is no dependency, so the **text** of **f**³⁵ must be ancient, dating at least to the IV century. There being no pattern or dependency, it will not do to claim that only the individual readings are ancient. Again I say, the evidence indicates that it is impossible that **f**³⁵ could be based on the Byzantine bulk. Anyone who continues to say so is uninformed, at best. Von Soden’s **K**^r should be retired and be replaced by **f**³⁵, or **f**¹⁸.

Down with Canards!¹

Once upon a time, a certain senior professor of Greek, at a certain Theological Seminary, sent me a personal communication affirming: “I hold with virtually all others that **K**^r/**M**⁷ are indeed late texts that reflect recensional activity beginning generally in the 12th century (perhaps with 11th century base exemplars, but nothing earlier).” And then a different Greek professor sent me another personal communication: “all of this based upon the **K**^r strand, of all things? TC’s who worked on this strand

¹ Dictionaries offer a variety of definitions for ‘canard’, but they all agree that it is false information, and imply that it was created with malicious intent. Of course those who repeat the canard may do so without malice, albeit they do so without checking the evidence.